FLAGSHIP HACKATHON · STATE LEVEL · TECH SPRINT

UTOPIA

CONCEPT • CODE • CONQUER

ORGANISED BY	DATE	TIME	VENUE
CEAS, DVVPCOE	07 April 2026	10:30 AM	DVVPCOE, Ahilyanagar

OVERVIEW

What is Utopia?

Forget the days of long-drawn coding — **UTOPIA** is where speed meets strategy. As the flagship hackathon of Cognostov 2026, this is a **high-intensity, state-level challenge** designed to bring together the brightest minds in coding and innovation.

Unlike traditional 24-hour marathons, UTOPIA is a **180-minute "tech-sprint"** that strips away the fluff — providing a high-pressure platform to test your core logic and ability to build a functional MVP under a strict, unforgiving clock.

This is not about endless debugging sessions or caffeine-fuelled all-nighters. This is about **clarity of thought, precision of execution**, and the ability to ship under pressure. The best engineers will rise.

EVENT HIGHLIGHTS

BUILD PHASE

180 min

Uninterrupted development window to build a functional prototype.

FOCUS

MVP

Ship a minimum viable product demonstrating your core concept.

EVENT STRUCTURE

Hackathon Structure

Two intensive phases. Every minute counts. Plan smart, build fast, present with confidence.

PHASE 01 The Build

3 Hours

- Teams receive **3 hours of uninterrupted development time** to build a functional prototype or implement core logic.
- All coding and development must be **completed within this strict 3-hour window** — no extensions granted.
- Open-source tools and AI assistants (ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot) may be used for assistance — not for complete project generation.
- Focus on shipping a **working MVP** that demonstrates the core functionality of your idea.

PHASE 02 The Showdown

2 Hours

- Teams will deliver **live demonstrations** before a jury panel of industry experts and faculty.
- Evaluation based on **innovation, technical execution, and functionality** — not just presentation aesthetics.
- Teams must be prepared to **answer technical questions** and justify their design and architectural decisions.
- The jury's decision will be **final and binding** — no appeals entertained under any circumstances.

REGISTRATION

Team Formation & Registration

TEAM INFORMATION

Team Size	1 to 5 members per team
Eligibility	Open to all eligible students
Cross-Inst.	Cross-institutional teams are permitted and encouraged
Entry Fee	₹250/- per team

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Program	B.Tech / B.E. engineering students (all branches)
Year	All academic years — 1st through 4th year
Branch	No restriction on branch or specialisation
Others	Diploma and all other technical course students

ENTRY FEE

₹250

PER TEAM · STATE-LEVEL OPEN

Register before the deadline. Carry your college ID card and registration confirmation on event day.

- Register your team before the official deadline — late registrations will not be accepted.
- Only one registration per team is allowed. No duplicate entries or last-minute team changes.
- All team members must carry a valid college ID card on the day of the event.

EVALUATION

Judging Criteria & Prizes

Projects will be evaluated across four dimensions by a jury panel. Build something worth remembering.

01

Innovation & Creativity

Is the idea fresh and original? Does it tackle a real-world problem in a novel way? Bold approaches are rewarded.

02

Technical Feasibility

Does the solution work as intended? Is the underlying architecture sound and scalable? Judges will look under the hood.

03

UI/UX & Functionality

How usable and intuitive is the product? Smooth user experience and clean design matter alongside core logic.

04

Presentation & Communication

Can you clearly articulate your idea and decisions? Storytelling and clarity count during the showdown phase.

PRIZES & PERKS

Cash Prizes— Awarded to winning teams across top positions

Goodies— Exclusive event merchandise for all participating teams

Certificates— Participation certificates issued to all registered participants

GUIDELINES

Participant Guidelines

Read these carefully. Familiarity with the rules is your responsibility — ignorance is not an excuse.

BEFORE THE HACKATHON

- Ensure your team is **registered and payment confirmed** before the deadline.
- Carry essentials: **laptop, charger, extension board**, and a valid college ID card.
- **Arrive on time** — late arrivals may not be accommodated once Build begins.
- Familiarise yourself with your tech stack — **the 3-hour window moves fast**.
- Prepare your dev environment, dependencies and frameworks **beforehand**.

HACKATHON RULES

- **No multiple registrations** or mid-event team switching.
- **Professional conduct** is mandatory — toward mentors, peers, and volunteers.
- All development must occur **within the official 3-hour window** only.
- AI tools may **assist** your work — not replace it. Misuse is grounds for disqualification.
- **Credit must be disclosed** for any AI tools or open-source resources used.

IMPORTANT NOTE

All participants are expected to maintain the highest standards of **academic and professional integrity** throughout the event. The organisers reserve the right to disqualify any team found in violation without prior notice.

INTEGRITY

Rules & Integrity

DISQUALIFICATION PARAMETERS

Plagiarism
Submitting previously built projects or presenting another person's work as your own original output.

Conduct Violations
Offensive, disrespectful, or disruptive behaviour toward mentors, jury members, or fellow participants.

Absence
Failing to appear or present [redacted] results in automatic disqualification.

AI Misuse
Using AI for complete project generation rather than assistance, or failing to credit AI-generated components.

PARTICIPATION AGREEMENT

- ✓ By registering, you agree to uphold **academic and professional integrity** throughout the event.
- ✓ Respect all **mentors, volunteers, and fellow participants** at all times without exception.
- ✓ Complete all development work strictly within the **official hackathon hours**.
- ✓ Present a **functional prototype** that is genuinely aligned with your submitted idea.
- ✓ All participants agree to comply with these terms and any **updates announced** by the organising committee.

UTOPIA

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